UX Design Thinking Process

Understanding the UX Design Thinking Process

- What is UX?
- Why UX Matters?
- What is UX Design?
- What is UX Design Thinking?
- Stages of UX Design Thinking

What is UX?

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UX stands for User Experience — it’s how a person feels when interacting with a product, app, or website.

A good UX means the product is easy to use, efficient, and enjoyable.

Example

- Using an app to order food in just 3 taps, smooth experience = good UX.
- Struggling to find the checkout button, frustrating = bad UX.

Why UX Matters?

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- Happy users stay longer, return more often.
- Saves time and effort for users.
- Directly impacts business success — more conversions, less support.
- Reduces frustration and makes products user-friendly.

What is UX Design?

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UX Design is the process of designing the entire experience a user has with a product.

It includes:

- Understanding the user's needs
- Planning structure & flow
- Creating and testing wireframes/prototypes
- Improving the product based on feedback

What is UX Design Thinking?

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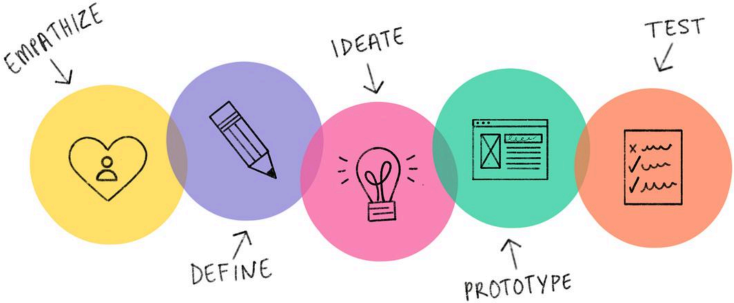
- A user-centered problem-solving approach.
- Helps designers create solutions that are useful, usable, and meaningful.
- Used by top companies like Google, Apple.
- Encourages empathy, creativity, and testing.

Stages of UX Design Thinking



Stage 1

Empathize

Understand the User

What Happens:

- Talk to users.
- Observe behaviors.
- Collect pain points, needs, emotions.

Goal

Understand the real problems your users face — not what you think they face.

Methods

- 1-on-1 interviews
- Surveys
- Empathy Maps
- User Shadowing
- Observation

Example

Interview 3 students:

- “What frustrates you when using the library website?”

Stage 2

Define

Find the real problem

What Happens:

- Analyze the data from Empathize.
- Find common issues or patterns.
- Write a clear problem statement.

Goal

Turn messy data into a clear design challenge.

Methods

- POV (Point of View) Statement
  “[User] needs a way to [do something] because [reason].”
- User Personas
- Journey Mapping

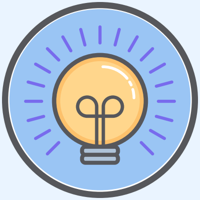
Example

- “Busy students need a quick way to check book availability because they often waste time searching manually.”

Stage 3

Ideate

Explore possible solutions



What Happens:

- Think of many ways to solve the problem.
- No judging ideas - creativity first, filtering later.

Goal

Generate diverse, innovative ideas.

Methods

- Brainstorming
- Crazy 8s
- Mind Mapping
- “How Might We” questions
  → How might we help students find books faster?

Example

- Add a barcode scanner to check books.
- Use color-coded search results.
- Add a “Reserve Book” button.

Stage 4

Prototype

Build testable designs

What Happens:

- Make low-fidelity versions of your idea (paper, wireframe, Figma).
- Focus on layout and function, not colors or beauty.

Goal

Create something testable, not perfect.

Methods

- Paper sketches
- Wireframes in Figma
- Clickable prototypes
- User flows

Example

Sketch 3 screens:

- Search → Book Info → Reserve Confirmation

Stage 5

Test

Improve through feedback

What Happens:

- Give your prototype to users.
- Watch how they use it.
- Ask what confused or frustrated them.

Goal

Improve the design based on real behavior, not guesses.

Methods

- Usability Testing
- A/B Testing
- Feedback Surveys
- Observation & Notes

Example

One student says:

“I didn’t see the reserve button. It should be larger.”

→ So, you redesign it to stand out more.